

JASPREET R VARAKALA

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PROFILE

Software Quality Assurance Leader with over 22+ years' experience in software testing and automation across Web, Mobile, and Client/Server applications. A recognized Subject Matter Expert (SME) in Tax Applications with 7+ years of specialized domain expertise. Distinguished for strong leadership, mentoring teams and consistent high-quality delivery of applications. Multiple recognitions, awards and accolades for exceptional software quality contributions. A trusted partner that delivers success and business value that aligns with clients expectations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Demonstrated expertise in established QA best practices, lead knowledge-sharing initiatives and drive continuous process improvements, efficiency and enhanced test coverage.
- Expertise in Automation testing with tools like Selenium, Unified Functional Testing (UFT), WinRunner, and API testing using Postman and RESTClient.
- Adept in writing complex SQL queries for backend/database testing and ascertaining data integrity across enterprise applications.
- Extensive experience in defect management and tracking, using tools like JIRA, Azure DevOps, ALM, Rally, and ensuring efficient resolution workflows.
- Expertise in Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) and Testing Life Cycle with hands-on experience in both Agile (Scrum, SAFe) and Waterfall, focusing on sprint planning, test strategy, and process optimization.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- Associate Degree in Computer Science - Iowa, IA
- Oracle Certified

TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

- **Software Development & Testing Environments:** Angular/React, C-Sharp (C#), TypeScript, IBM BPM, Drupal (Content management system), Ruby, Ruby on Rails, Java, JavaScript, CSS3/HTML5, VBScript, ASP.Net, Windows XP, Linux/Unix
- **Automation Tools:** Selenium, Unified Functional Testing (UFT), WinRunner, Quick Test Professional (QTP)
- **API Testing Tools:** Postman, RESTClient, sFTP
- **Database:** SQL Server, DB2, PeopleSoft 8.0
- **Project Management Tools:** Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, ALM (Application Lifecycle Management), Rally
- **Defect Tracking & Reporting Tools:** Jira, TestDirector, Azure DevOps, HP ALM
- **Web Crawling & SEO Tools:** DigitalPulse Debugger, Omniture SiteCatalyst, SortSite Web Crawling
- **Miscellaneous Tools:** Empirix e-Manager, Microsoft Test Manager 2017

EXPERIENCE

Ernst & Young (EY), Alpharetta, GA

April 2016 - Mar 2025

QA Manager

RAPToR is an advanced Tax Compliance solution built to handle partnership and partner tax processes, encompassing taxable income calculations, adjustments, partner allocations, and comprehensive IRS filings. RAPToR serves some of the largest global real estate firms, private equity firms, investment banks and corporations.

- **Leadership:** Led a team of fifteen (15), we delivered complex, microservices-based tax applications. Ascertained seamless testing across multiple modules within tight timelines, testing entailed complex Federal and State tax calculations. Established a structured QA framework, aligned team effort across varied modules and fostered cross-functional collaboration.
- **Process Optimization & Knowledge Sharing:** Implemented an end-to-end testing strategy, organize learning sessions on modules interactions. To enhance QA effectiveness reinforced best practices for data setup and process alignment. To streamline releases and mitigate risks introduced structured sprint planning and deployment coordination.
- **Test Strategy & Automation Integration:** To align with business objectives and advance automation efforts, I designed and implemented a balanced testing strategy with a 50-50 split between manual and automated testing. I led the development of a BDD (Behavior-Driven Development) automation framework using Selenium WebDriver with C# and SpecFlow, ensuring test cases were both readable and maintainable. Managed the automation test suite and CI/CD pipeline in Azure DevOps, and spearheaded automation-driven regression and smoke testing to reduce manual effort and ensure continuous application stability. In addition to overseeing the overall QA strategy, I remained hands-on, working closely with the team to execute both manual and automated test cases across critical modules.
- **Performance & Scalability Assurance:** Integrated performance testing within feature validation, proactively identified scalability and prevented failures for data volume growth.
- **Domain Expertise & Functional Oversight:** Ensured seamless functionality of complex tax logic across key modules, including client and ownership data management, accounting and EY standard setup, partnership tax calculations and allocations, standard report generation, and IRS filings with tax form processing. Provided functional inputs to the Product Owner groups, identified requirements gaps, aligned end-users expectations and ensured developers understanding of QA expectations.
- **Cross-Team Collaboration & Agile Best Practices:** Effectively managed QA-to-Developer ratio, ensured efficient resources utilization and team's upskilling. Encouraged progressive task complexity, leveraged team's strengths to enhance upskilling and subject matter expertise.

QA Lead - Project RAPToR (Consultant via TCS)

- Led QA functional and automation efforts for RAPToR core products, including TIM (Taxable Income Module) and CAM (Chart of Account Module). Oversight of full lifecycle of the Tax Calcs process, conducted business domain analysis, maintained integration and regression test suites, and comprehensive features functional and regression testing.
- Collaborated with Product Owners, Stakeholders, and Business teams to define and prioritize quality initiatives throughout the SDLC.
- Developed and maintained test data to validate both current and new features, ensuring compliance with standards and technical requirements. Provided strategic guidance for anticipated test challenges, planning and execution.
- Managed testing across UAT, Staging, and Production environments, and for timely defect resolution collaborated with development teams. Led checkpoint/status calls with cross-functional teams to review progress and secure release approvals.
- Tracked defects in Azure DevOps, managing issue resolution and handling escalations.
- Generated sprint metrics, including resource distribution, test case execution, and defect root cause analysis to drive continuous improvement.

QA Analyst (Consultant via TCS)

- **Project PE/RE:** Executed end to end testing for EY Taxspace (PE/RE) application developed on the IBM BPM platform. This application is designed to handle taxable income data preparation and generate Partner K1s for EY's Private Equity and Real Estate clients. Engaged in the Report Server Project, assigned to export data from EY Taxspace (PE/RE) to client-specific databases. Validated export process to ensure expected data is propagated in target tables. Executed API testing with Postman and RESTClient services across multiple environments and tested data uploads using sFTP. Created and updated Agile, E2E, ETL, API, and sFTP test cases based on Sprint's user stories in DevOps and conducted Smoke testing, End to end functional, system and regression testing. Active participation in daily Scrums, Stand-up's and team meetings to discuss status, scenarios, issues and tracked defects in DevOps.
- **PCS Project:** Led Agile QA efforts for the PCS (Private Client Service) application, developed on IBM BPM Tool, to manage Main Agreement (MA) and Statement of Work (SOW) approval processes for EY's client services. Coordinated with business and feature teams, attended sprint grooming meetings to discuss future stories and story points, and contributed to grooming new resources and coordinating with the South America team. Developed and executed test cases based on user stories to ensure smooth functional alignment with business requirements

Time Inc. / American Express Publishing, New York, NY

Oct 2010 - July 2015

(Time Inc. acquired American Express Publishing in Oct 2013)

QA Lead

- Managed onsite and offshore QA teams, oversight for testing data center migrations (SAVVIS to AWS) and applications migration (Ruby to Drupal) executed under tight deadlines. Worked in an Agile development environment, performing cross-browser testing (Firefox, Chrome, Safari, IE) and mobile testing on various devices (iPhone, iPad, Nexus, Samsung Galaxy).
- Accountable for web applications testing including travelandleisure.com, foodandwine.com and departures.com, ascertain seamless functionality across desktop and mobile platforms. Introduced innovative methods to enhance software quality, test coverage, efficiency, and regression coverage. Collaborated with project managers, editors, designers, SEO experts, and developers (both onsite and offshore) to define project scope and requirements.
- Debugged front-end issues related to JavaScript, CSS, and HTML, and performed SEO content/keyword testing to enhance search visibility.
- Automated testing using Selenium for link validation and tracked defects using JIRA, leading bug scrub meetings to assist developers in issue resolution.

Volt Information Sciences, Inc. New York, NY

Feb 2005 - Oct 2009

QA Analyst

- Liaise with Project Managers, Business Analysts and Developers to addresses quality considerations. (i.e. testability, reliability, maintainability, etc.) during analysis, design and testing phases.
- Accountable to review functional requirements, created and updated test plans and cases, and conducted end-to-end testing for customized client applications such as Pfizer, Eli Lilly, AT&T, Avaya, Aetna, Verizon, Ingersoll Rand, and Wells Fargo.
- Ascertain defects resolution and fixes were moved to related environments and generated defects reports in reporting tool.
- Developed QTP automation scripts for Smoke and Regression testing, performed SQL-based back-end testing, and validated extracted data against client records. Generated billing processes, extracted and validated data against related client's records and ensured data accuracy in the PSI database (PeopleSoft 8.0 Interface).

Prudential Financial Group, Roseland, NJ

Aug 2004 - Jan 2005

QA Analyst

Accountable to test mutual funds and stocks client's transaction system. Ascertained seamless integration with updated mainframe systems. Developed test plans, test scripts, test cases, traceability matrices and defect reports for outsourced data warehouse facilities while facilitating QA review meetings with development and management teams. Performed systems and integration testing using SQL queries, UNIX shell scripts and TSO/Mainframe tools to validate batch processes and outsourced system records. Utilized Mercury Test Director to track defects, execute test cases, and generate progress reports for executive stakeholders.

Reinsurance Group of America, Inc., St. Louis, MO

Oct 2003 - Aug 2004

QA Analyst

Responsible for functional, regression, integration, sanity, and performance testing for AURA (Automated Underwriting & Risk Analysis, an enterprise insurance application. Ensured accuracy of XML output files and developed automated data-driven scripts for administrative components. Reviewed business and technical requirements to develop, update and execute test plans, test cases, and test matrices. Ensured alignment with system changes and client-specific customizations. Used SOS (Source-Off-Site) defect tracking to report and manage issues, collaborated with the development team to prioritize fixes and maintain defect lists. Ensured XML output files matched application results.